

— EDITION 41

An agent that cites its sources and still cannot ship itself

I built an agent that researches a story, writes it with inline citations, checks that every citation resolves, and commits the result to git. It cannot push.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 07

| It researches.

Pulls the story together from source material on its own, no brief drafted for it in advance.

0202 / 07

| It cites.

Every claim carries an inline citation as it is written, not bolted on afterwards as a source list.

0303 / 07

| It checks its own citations.

Each link is resolved before the post is treated as finished. A citation that fails to resolve blocks the run.

0404 / 07

| It commits.

A clean local commit, every time, with a message that describes exactly what changed.

0505 / 07

| It cannot push.

The sandbox has no GitHub credentials. Every run ends with a one-line instruction to push it myself when I am back at my machine.

0606 / 07

The reason it cannot push.

I could grant write access. I have not, on purpose. A wrong publish is expensive and hard to unwind, and that is exactly the step I keep a human hand on.

0707 / 07

| Full autonomy, except at the door.

Everywhere else in the pipeline the agent runs unattended. At the publish boundary, it stops and waits for me.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Automate to the expensive step, then **stop.**

Where do you draw the line between what an agent should do and what it should only prepare? Follow Joseph Bankole for more field notes from real AI deploys.

◆ Joseph Bankole